

August

4

2006 X-treme stunt

US motocross racer Travis Pastrana performed the first-ever double backflip on a motorcycle at the 12th X Games in Los Angeles, USA. He earned the top score of 98.6 and finished the games with three gold medals.



2011 First electric helicopter

French engineer Pascal Chretien, who built the electric-powered Solution F/Chretien helicopter, flew it for the first time on this day. Tethered to the ground, the aircraft hovered 50 cm (19 in) off the ground for just over two minutes.

Also on this day

1944 After more than two years in hiding, Jewish teenager Anne Frank and her family were found and arrested by Nazi officials in Amsterdam, Netherlands.

1945 One of the world's first electronic bugs (listening devices) was hidden in the study of the US ambassador in Moscow. For the next seven years, Soviet agents used it to spy on the USA, before it was discovered.

2020 A massive explosion in a warehouse at the Port of Beirut, Lebanon, severely injured 6,500 people and killed more than 200.

Born this day

1901 Louis Armstrong, Black American trumpet player and singer. He transformed jazz music with his performances and unique singing style.

1929 Kishore Kumar, Indian singer and actor. He sang more than 2,000 songs in different Indian languages.

Siege of Odawara 1590

The Hōjō clan surrendered to the army of samurai lord Toyotomi Hideyoshi, ending the three-month-long siege of Odawara Castle. This event marked a step towards Hideyoshi's unification of Japan.

